CONVULSIONS—EPILEPTIC, INFANTILE, PUERPERAL, HYDROPHOBIC, TETANIC.

Epilepsy proximately depends on unbalanced circulation, this being due to pressure somewhere, in the cerebro-spinal or other nervous tissue, even upon the cerebro-spinal mass itself, as in the region of the foramen magnum, or elsewhere, in the form of indurated tissue, usually below the medulla oblongata, impeding its free movement in the canal.

The first effort must be to dispose of this collection of morbid matter. The second effort to correct a multitude of local troubles, which are liable to concur with the main affection, especially of the throat, bronchi, nasal passages, and stomach, all of which seem to get better or worse as the general malady changes.

During the spasm, apply No. 2 electrode to base of brain in A, No. 6 electrode on the soles of the feet very hot in D, as strong as the operator's judgment dictates, until patient seems better. Change A to No. 4 electrode, and place between the hands; or if the patient is incapable of holding it, apply instead from the lower part of breast-bone, twenty minutes; follow in half or three-quarters of an hour with A–C, or C–E, in the same way; the former, if the surface generally is warm; the latter, if cold, especially the extremities.

Chronic epilepsy:

First. Seat the patient on No. 7 electrode in G, sponge-cup to be rubbed from base of brain to end of spine in E, ten minutes; change to A–D current ten minutes longer.